

THE PROXY

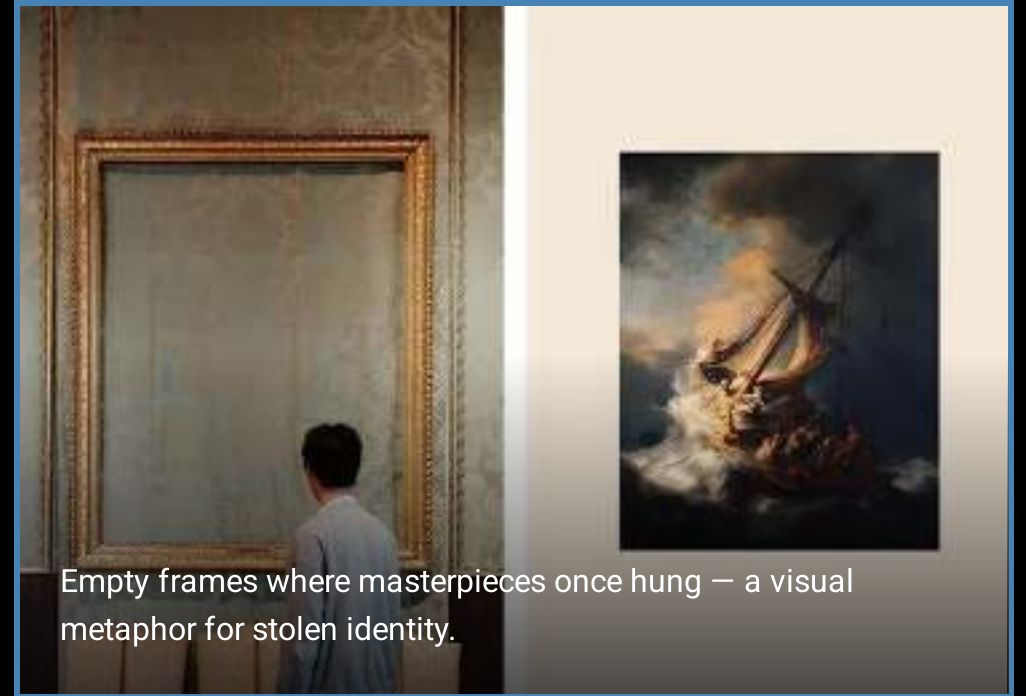
When they mistook her for a powerful woman, she played along to survive. Now she's taking it all back.

Created by: Kelly R. Tenney

LOGLINE

When a **struggling single mother** is mistaken for a **high-profile art dealer** during a violent gallery heist, she plays along to stay alive.

But when she learns the real woman orchestrated it all, **Monique** must infiltrate the art world's underbelly to expose the truth—and reclaim the identity that was nearly stolen forever.



TONE & GENRE

Thriller meets Intimate Drama

- A psychological identity thriller with the emotional richness of a coming-into-power journey.
- Grounded romance woven through a mother-son survival story.
- Social legacy tension— art, Black identity, and cultural theft in a post-viral world.

THINK:



Killing Eve *meets* **The Undoing**



Queen & Slim *meets* **Inside Man**



A splash of **The Crown** *meets* **Atlanta**

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

THE PROXY is about:



Stolen identity and **stolen art**



Power from invisibility



A woman using the **illusion of status** to reclaim her truth



Legacy, authenticity, and who gets to tell the story



Revenge wrapped in elegance



It's a survival story, a social reckoning, and a slow-burn character transformation—with heart, teeth, and paintbrushes.

CHARACTER PROFILES

MONIQUE DAVENPORT

Our Hero



- 33. Black. A waitress. A mother. An artist with no name on the wall.
- Sharp. Resourceful. Tired of just surviving.
- Untrained but brilliant painter—her art is raw, intuitive, deeply personal.
- Her relationship with her son grounds her. But now she must lie to protect them both.

"From Impostor to Architect of Her Own Power."

BIANCA ST. JAMES

The Mirror



- 40s. Black. A luxury gallery owner with cartel connections and impeccable taste.
- Powerful, cold, calculating.
- Built her empire stealing art—and identities—from women like Monique.
- She didn't mistake Monique. She chose her.

"She is what Monique might have been—if the world hadn't decided otherwise."

THEMES

Art as Identity. Legacy as Leverage.

- ? *Who owns the story?*
- ? *What happens when a Black woman steals back what was taken?*
- ? *How do we fight the systems that erase us—without becoming them?*

Explores:



Cultural theft & repatriation



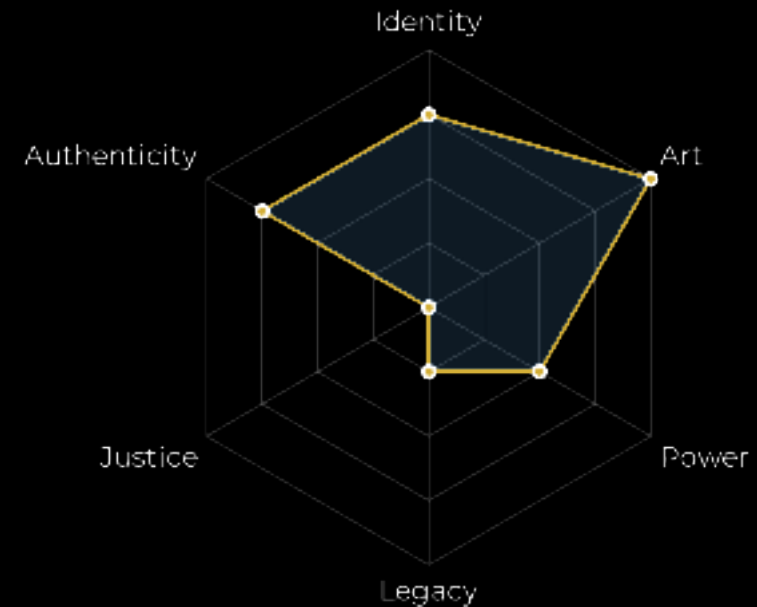
Single motherhood & Black creativity



Digital mythology, social media spectacle



Power, wealth, erasure, and revenge



WORLD & VISUAL STYLE

Atlanta.

Gentrified art galleries. Historic Black neighborhoods. Corporate glitz meets street hustle.



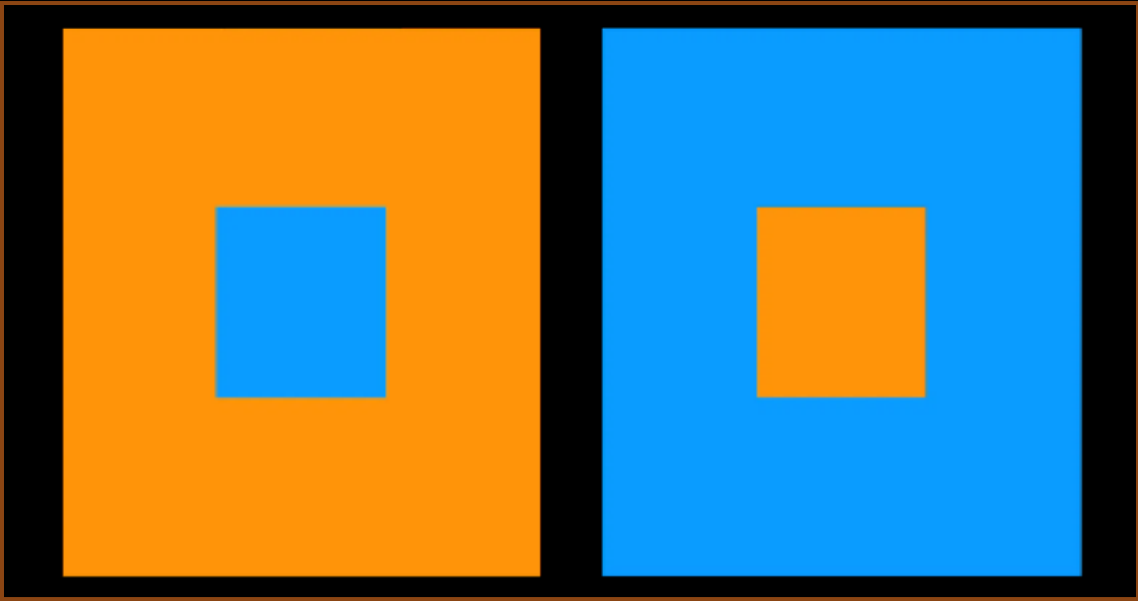
Visual Contrast

Monique's World:

Warm colors — texture, clutter, life.

Bianca's World:

Cold minimalism — sterility, luxury, curated danger.



Visual style transitions from warm to cool as Monique navigates between worlds

Camera & Tone:

Handheld intimacy transitions into **elegant framing** as Monique gains power.

Close-ups linger on paint, skin, expression, breath.

Digital overlays, social feeds, security footage heighten tension & identity blur.

ROMANCE THREAD

Monique & Jordan Rivers

A reluctant partnership becomes emotional friction. Their connection evolves from suspicion to trust, and ultimately to something deeper.

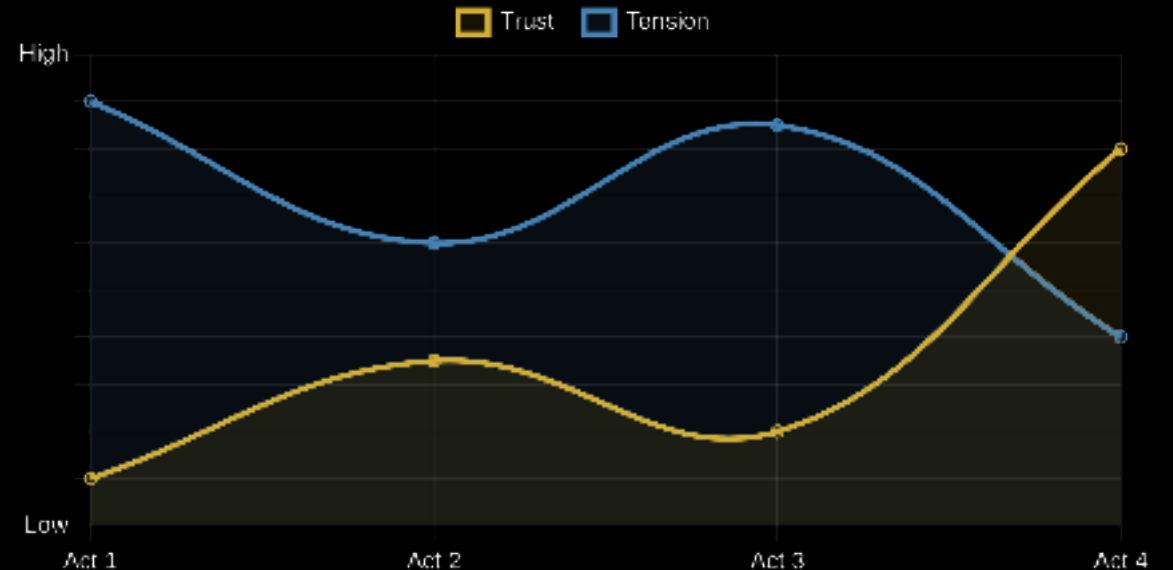
- ◆ He's an ex-cop turned fixer who once worked for Bianca.
- ◆ Trust is hard-earned, tension-filled, and always walking a knife's edge.
- ◆ Their love story is less about rescue—and more about **awakening**.

||

You're not her replacement. You're her reckoning.

— Jordan to Monique

Relationship Evolution



FORMAT & STRUCTURE

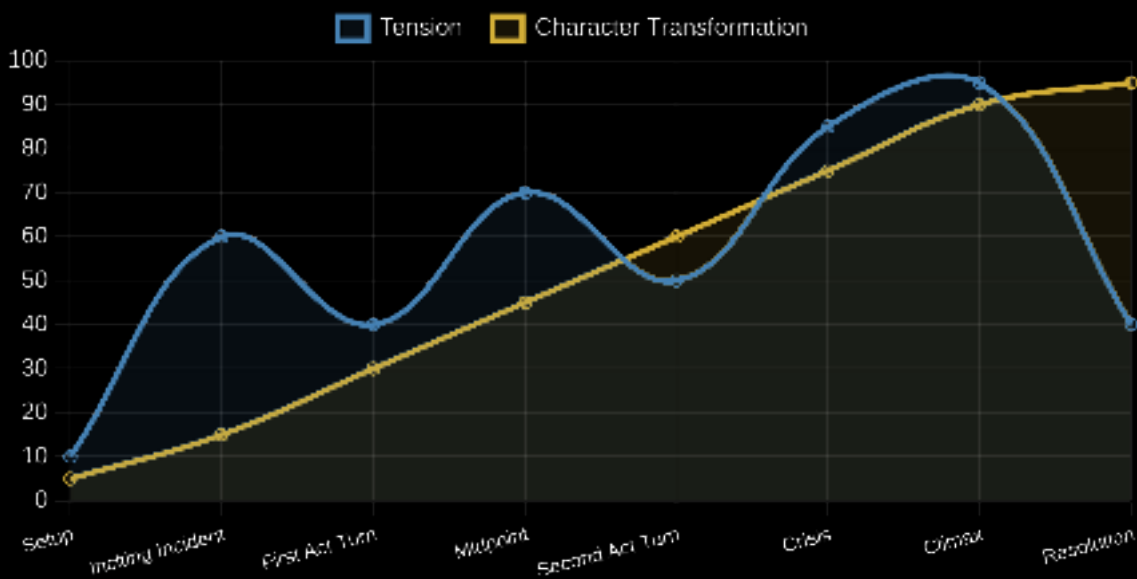
Feature Film

Runtime: 100–110 minutes

Structure: Thriller with act breaks

Pacing: Slow-burn with escalating tension

Narrative Arc



* Chart shows tension and character transformation across the film's runtime

Act Structure

ACT I The Mistaken Identity

Monique is mistaken for Bianca during a gallery heist. She plays along to survive, discovering a world of luxury and power she never had access to.

ACT II The Infiltration

Learning Bianca orchestrated the mistaken identity, Monique partners with Jordan to infiltrate the art world and uncover the truth behind Bianca's scheme.

ACT III The Revelation

Monique discovers Bianca has been stealing and selling her artwork for years. Their confrontation reveals deeper connections between them than either knew.

ACT IV The Reclamation

Monique turns the tables, using Bianca's own tactics against her to reclaim her identity, her art, and forge a new path forward on her own terms.

AUDIENCE & MARKET FIT

For fans of:

- Sharp Objects
- Killing Eve
- I May Destroy You
- The Undoing
- Queen & Slim

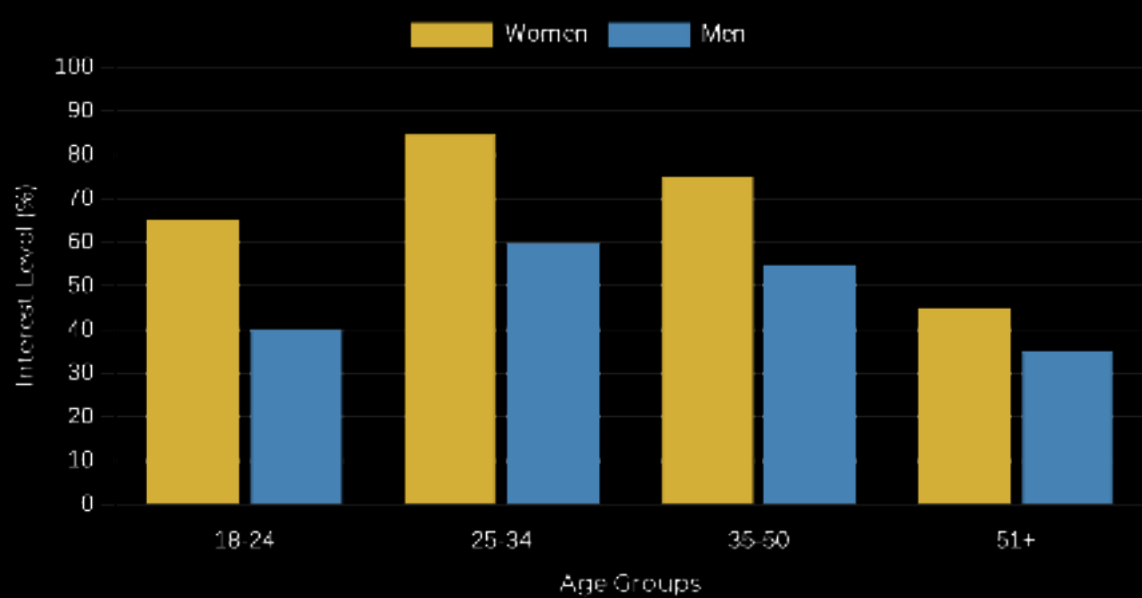
Target Audience:

- Women 25–50
- BIPOC creators and social justice thinkers
- True crime + art world enthusiasts
- Viewers seeking elevated, character-driven thrillers with emotional depth

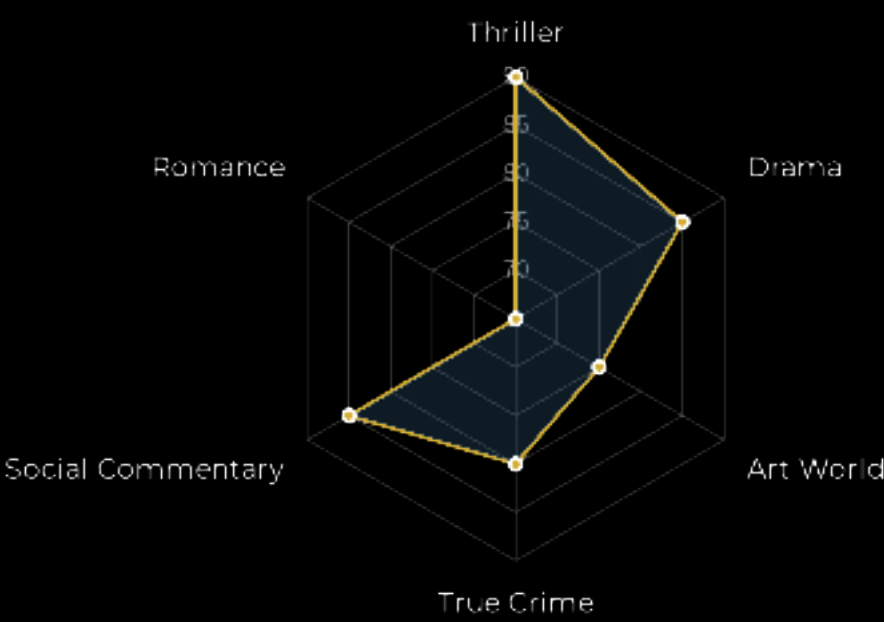
POTENTIAL PLATFORMS

- HBO
- Netflix
- Amazon Prime
- Hulu
- Peacock

Audience Demographics



Genre Interest Overlap



WHY NOW



Cultural theft and appropriation are center-stage globally.



Black stories about identity, survival, and artistry have mainstream power.



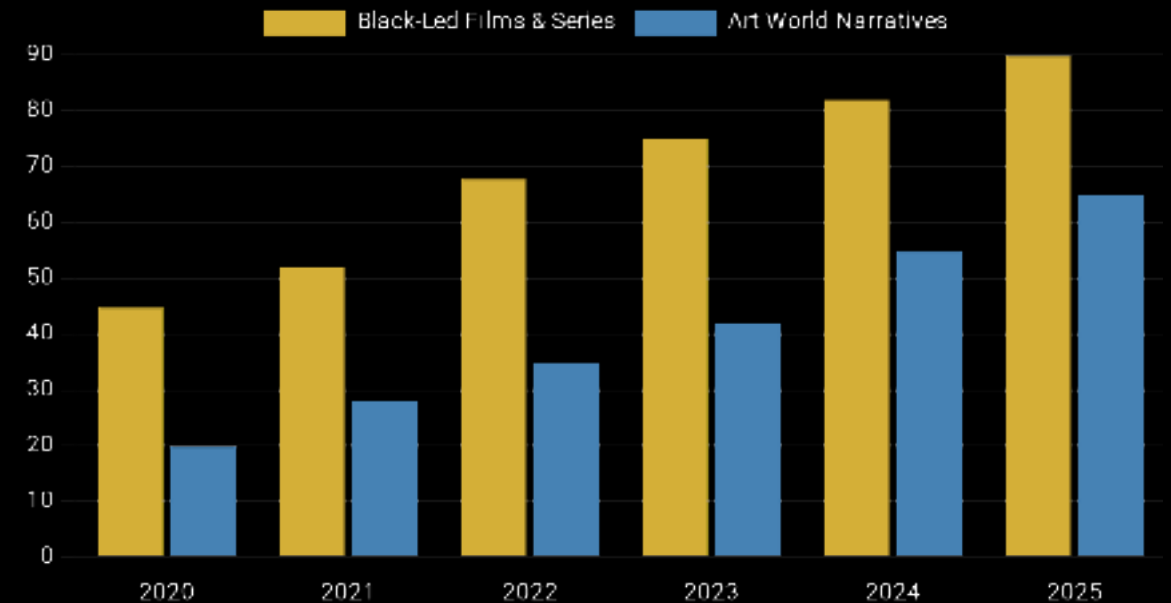
"Mistaken identity" narratives are ripe for social and emotional subversion.



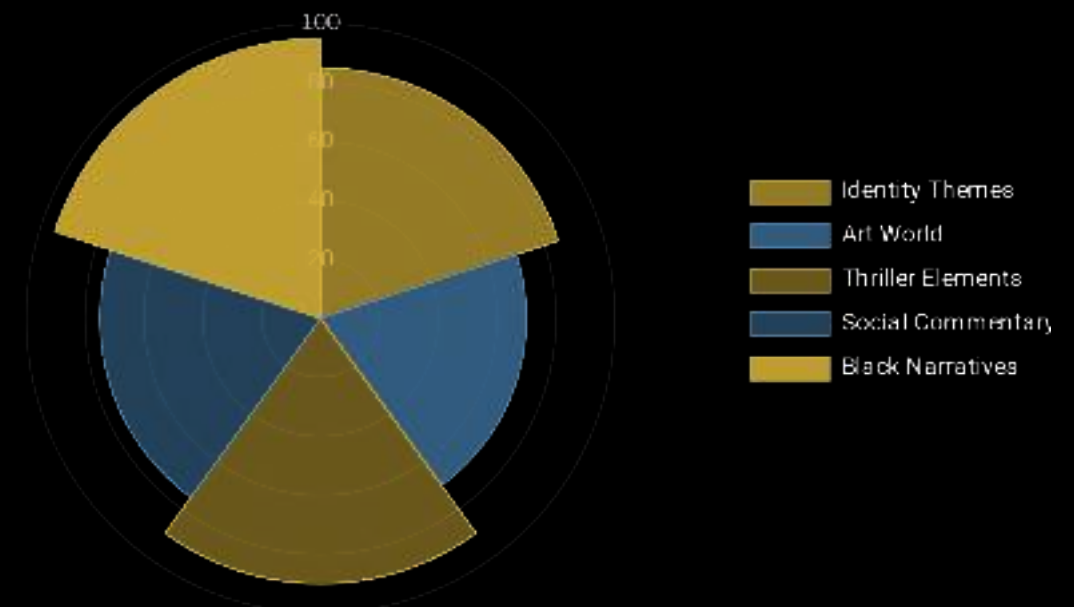
The Proxy speaks to **modern erasure**—and what it takes to be seen.

A story that resonates with audiences seeking authentic representation and complex narratives about power, identity, and justice.

Rising Cultural Trends



Audience Interest by Theme



PRODUCTION NOTES

🎬 Tone & Rating

R for thematic intensity, adult language, and violence

📍 Setting

Modern-day **Atlanta**

🎨 Visual Style

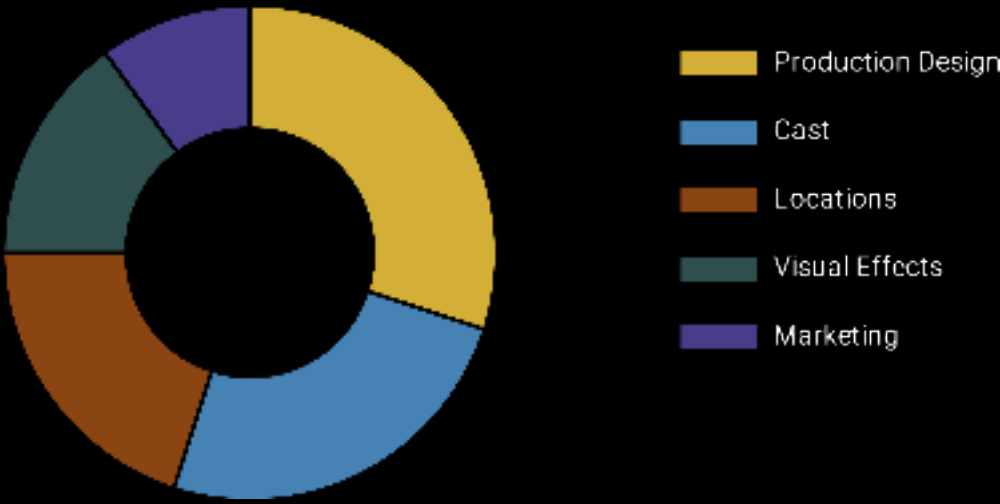
Prestige, elevated, art-forward

👤 Casting

Lead roles ideal for powerhouse talent—flexible for big-name or breakout actress



Budget Allocation Priority



FRANCHISE POTENTIAL

Beyond the Feature Film: Expanding THE PROXY Universe



Anthology Series

Each season follows a different stolen identity, legacy battle, or cultural theft narrative.



Docu-style Companion

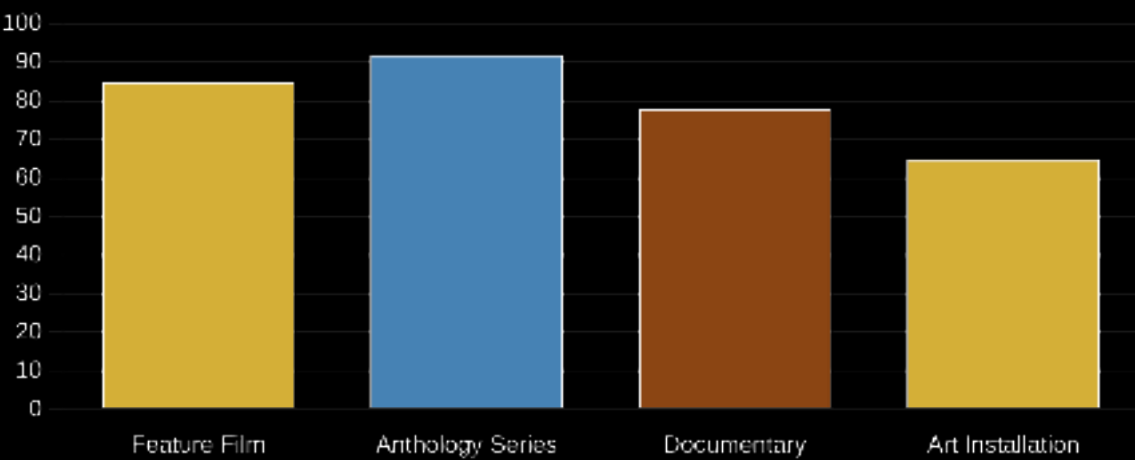
Real stories of repatriated art, forged identity, and exploitation that inspired the fictional narrative.



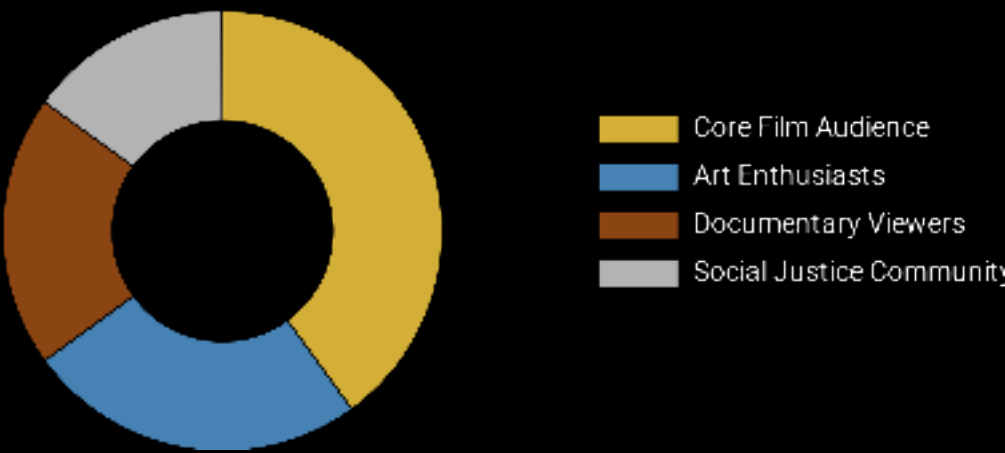
Art Exhibit / Installation

Partner with Black visual artists to exhibit "reclaimed works" from the story.

Franchise Format Potential



Audience Expansion Opportunities



FINAL IMAGE + TAGLINE

Poster Concept:

Monique, framed by gallery lighting. Behind her—masked intruders. Beside her—her own stolen painting, signed by someone else.

- **Visual Contrast:** Warm lighting on Monique against cold, sterile gallery background
- **Composition:** Monique centered but slightly off-balance, suggesting her precarious position
- **Symbolism:** Empty frames and shadowy figures represent stolen identity and art
- **Typography:** Bold, elegant font with gold accents reflecting the art world's luxury

**They stole her face.
She's taking back
everything else.**

